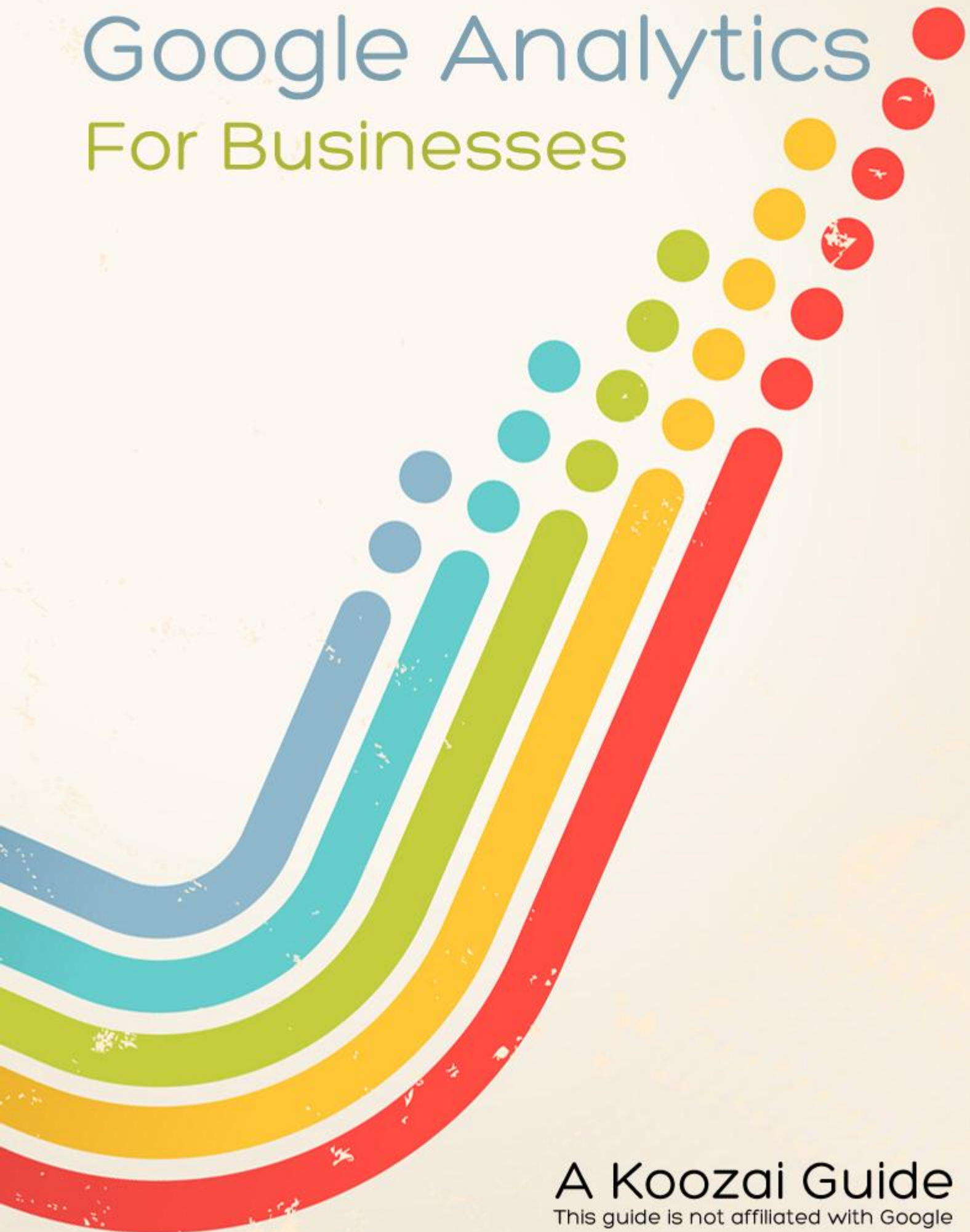


The Practical Guide To Google Analytics For Businesses



A Koozai Guide
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The Practical Guide To Google Analytics For Businesses

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A Little Bit About Koozai:

Koozai are a multi-award winning digital marketing agency.

We're one of the UK's fastest growing technology companies having been ranked 23rd in the Deloitte Technology Fast50.

We help businesses connect with their customers online – providing a range of industry-leading services from Organic Search Engine Optimisation (SEO) and Pay Per Click (PPC) Management to Link Building, Social Media and Brand Management.

We thrive on building long-lasting client relationships and delivering true value for money. We're passionate about what we do - and that shows in our work.

No lengthy contracts, just world class Digital Marketing. Koozai will help you build your brand online and achieve ROI that can be clearly measured against your bottom line.



How To Get In Touch:

If you would like to get in touch with us, please visit our website (www.koozai.com) or use one of the methods below:



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/koozai



/koozai

About The Authors:



Anna Lewis; (@Koozai_Anna)

Role: Digital Marketing Executive

Google Analytics Experience: 3+ years' advanced use

Favourite aspect of analytics: Being able to actually show how much value, specific work has generated for a business is the best bit. Knowing you generated a good ROI is the perfect pat on the back.

Bio: Our resident analytics specialist is Anna Lewis. Anna is unbelievably attuned to anything analytical and can fill you in on all the latest news, tips and advice to get ahead in this evolving market.

Graeme Benge; (@Koozai_Graeme)

Role: Digital Marketing Executive

Google Analytics Experience: 1+ years' advanced use

Favourite aspect of analytics: Rank tracking with Event tracking really knocked my socks off; I love these sort of customisations!

Bio: With five years background in Travel, Graeme has built up strong commercial experience alongside online and offline marketing skills working with a variety of Travel Agents and Cruise Specialists. A passionate advocate of SEO and Social Media, Graeme has a strong interest in ROI and analytics in order to deliver the best level of returns.



Why Analytics?

When you have a website, the data behind it is fundamental to understanding what is happening and whether your website is successful. A good implementation of tracking code allows you to collect important data to help you make informed decisions to improve your site, make it better for users and make it more profitable.

This Whitepaper has the following chapters:

1. Where to find the best data
2. Custom and more Advanced Reports
3. Customising and Segmenting Reports
4. How to set up Google Analytics for your Business
5. Google Analytics Glossary

Sections 1 and 2 cover the reports available, focussing on the most beneficial ones and providing you with the information required to make key decisions about your site based on your data.

Section 3 will help you speed up reporting and get more from Google Analytics with Advanced Segments and Custom Reports.

Section 4 covers tracking code implementations (from basic to advanced) for Google Analytics, outlining the benefits of each method and important aspects to be aware of.

Finally, section 5 is a glossary to help you understand common analytics terminology.

1. Where to find the best data:

Google Analytics Reports – Standard Reports

By Graeme Bengie

We're going to take you through the reports that are most beneficial for websites, firstly covering the standard reports that don't require customisations or in depth knowledge and the second part of this section will cover those that do!

The content here covers the reports found immediately within the Google Analytics console. Once you've successfully logged into Google Analytics, the left hand navigation bar presents 5 standard report menus. We are going to concentrate on some of the most beneficial and commonly used reports:

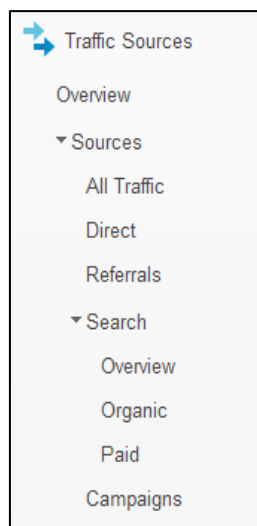


- Traffic Sources
- Technology
- Ecommerce
- Goals

Let get started!

Traffic Sources

This is likely to be the first port of call for most analytics users. In the traffic sources menu the data drills down to the granular traffic source types.



Once selected, each of these reports will all provide top level interaction data:

Visits 10,234,567 % of Total: 100.00%	Pages / Visit 25.777 Site Avg: 10.00%	Avg. Visit Duration 00:00:25.777 Site Avg: 00:00:25.777	% New Visits 100.000% Site Avg: 100.000%	Bounce Rate 100.000% Site Avg: 100.000%
---	---	---	--	---

The All Traffic Report

Clicking on this report will give you the total visits the particular profile (and filters) has collected for your site over the stated time frame.

This data can be further refined using the following Primary Dimensions:

Source/Medium: A combination of traffic source and type

Source: A data set tailored by traffic source

Medium: The traffic type

Other: This dimension allows All Traffic data to be set using metrics from other factors such as browser type, content viewed, traffic sources and more.

The Direct Traffic Report

Delving into the Direct report will show you visit data refined by landing page from visitors that have navigated to your page in one of two ways:

- Typed the URL directly into their browser
- Have clicked on a saved bookmark

The Referral Traffic Report

From this report we get to see what traffic has come in from third party sites. The Primary Dimensions let you drill down at **Source** level, by **Landing Page** that received the visit or by **Other** to refine the data by the other dimensions available.

Search Category

This subset of reports pulls data from the two search networks; organic and paid.

The Overview Report

This report typically gets overlooked however it does give a good initial summary of how the two traffic streams compare. There are Primary Dimensions to further refine the data however if you're looking to drill down deeper then the next set of reports will give you much more insight.

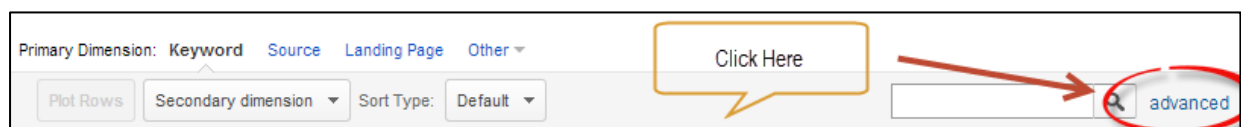
The Organic Traffic Report

Organic search traffic is where your data starts to really come alive. So to be clear, within this report, the data you are viewing is based on traffic sent to your site by organic or natural search engine listings and nothing else. Once you start to play with all the different controls, you will still only be viewing organic traffic. This means there is a lot of tinkering that can be done to gain insight into how your site is being found.

The Primary Dimensions default to **Keyword**, revealing the keywords used to find your site. Here in descending order you're likely to see (not provided) as your top keyword and then depending on the strength of your brand, your brand or product keywords.

At this stage it's good to see what volume of visits your brand or product based terms are bringing in but the real discoveries lie in excluding those terms and the "long tail" terms that are likely to make up xx% of keywords used to find your site.

To do this we need to add an advanced filter. Follow these screenshots and watch how your data transforms:



This will open up the following section of your **Keyword** report:



Now we can exclude our brand terms. There are a number of ways to achieve this.

Exclude a keyword containing one of the following match types...

- Exactly matching – there is no messing here, only keywords spelt the exact same way will be removed
- Matching RegExp – this is mindbender to start with but so useful. We explain more (with examples in the Glossary) so don't panic now!
- Begins With – this filter excludes terms that begin with a set of characters but may have variants at the end of the keyword
- Ends With – as you would expect this is the opposite of the above and excludes keywords that end with your criteria
- Containing – putting this filter to work excludes keywords with your keyword mid string

The data you now have on view should be a lovely list of keywords that ARE NOT branded terms. At this stage you'll have some standard metrics that will give you some insight into how your site users interact. This particular exercise is well worth carrying out to understand how your audience is finding your site. You may find a number of factors influence the keywords you see in this filtered report.

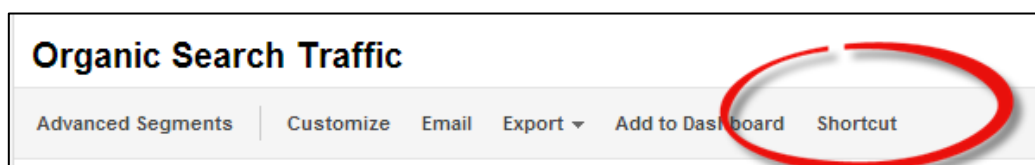
Having got used to how you can refine this set of data you can also perform the opposite exercise using "Include" as the starting command of the filter. This could be used to include only branded terms (by consequence exclude all long tail terms) so you can see specifically the contribution your brand terms and variants of provide your site.

Pro Tip

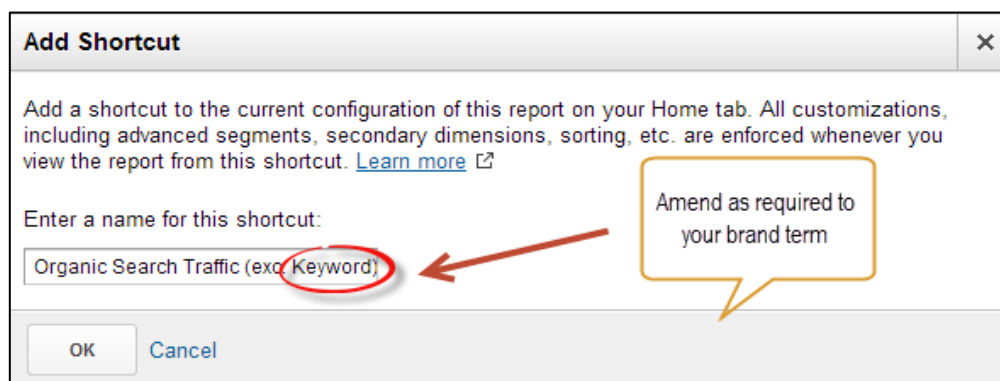
After a few goes using the different configurations, you are likely to settle on a filter that returns the type of results that will give you the ability to make informed decisions about the direction of your site.

Don't go through the rigmarole of setting this all up again. Simply add this to your **Shortcuts** found in the **My Stuff** section of the left hand pane of the Google Analytics console.

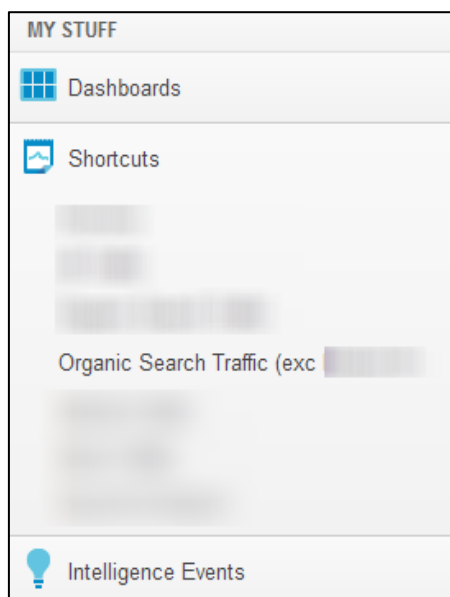
This is how you do it (and save a lot of profanity when you come to repeat the exercise but forget how you configured the filter!). First, head to the top of the screen and click on **Shortcut**:



Next, label your shortcut something memorable such as "Organic Search Traffic (exc: Keyword)" and change the keyword as appropriate.



You'll be able to quickly go back to this using the **Shortcuts** menu:



You can create **Shortcuts** for any customised reports you make in Google Analytics as long as you can see the Shortcut button in that navigation bar towards the top of the console's page.

A Word On (not provided) Data

In 2012 Google made changes to their privacy terms that now mean keyword data by users signed into a Google account won't be passed through to Google Analytics. To account for this data Google Analytics combines it and reports it as (not provided).

For some sites this can account for up to 60% of keyword information and some people predict the age of "100% (not provided)" arriving in the near future.

We have written a blog post on ways to get around the (not provided) issue:

<http://www.koozai.com/blog/analytics/surviving-not-provided-keywords-in-google-analytics/>

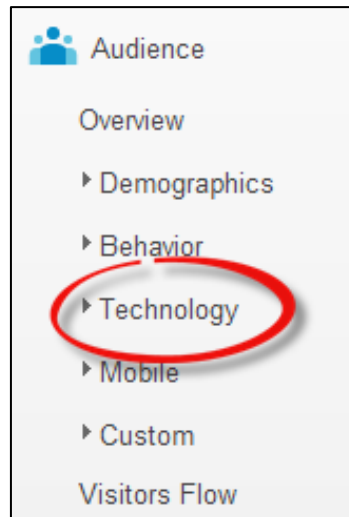
The Paid Traffic Report

Use this report to verify that AdWords and Analytics have been successfully linked together. You can get an overview of AdWords performance from here but given the differences in how Analytics and AdWords attribute clicks and also the AdWords console itself provides an excellent means of analysing data specific to Paid search.

That covers the most commonly used reports within the **Traffic Sources** set of Analytics report.

Technology

Google Analytics is centred on delivering information about websites, however one of the recent updates that shows how useful the tool has become to businesses, is the **Technology** report found within the **Audience** set of reports.



From here you can view data on the following aspects of user technology:

- Browsers type
 - Operating system
 - Screen Resolution
 - Screen Colours
 - Flash Version
- Network
 - Service provider

Pro Tip

There are some quick wins to be had here. If you're finding pages with Flash content are underperforming, have a look to see how much of your audience uses iOS. Remember, Apple didn't integrate Flash in iOS meaning Flash content is rendered un-viewable which could cause issues with user experience and have a knock on effect to Bounce Rate, Time on Site and other interaction metrics.

A really valuable report to make a mental note of/write on a sticky note is the **Hostname** report.

From here you can see the domains that Google Analytics is pulling data from by using your UA code. If you have implemented Cross Domain or Sub Domain tracking, those domains will show here. Should you see a strange domain, you may have found someone that is copying your site.

Conversions

Goals

Every website has objectives. By utilising Goal tracking websites can measure what objectives are met and which ones need to be promoted more, thus improving results.

Goals in Google Analytics can track URLs viewed, Events triggered, pages per visit and time on site.

It is beneficial to make a list of all website objectives and important tasks on the site. These can then be reviewed and tracked where possible. Please bear in mind that each profile can have up to a maximum of 20 goals so having a list of business objectives mapped to your list of 20 goals will see that as many objectives are being measured as possible.

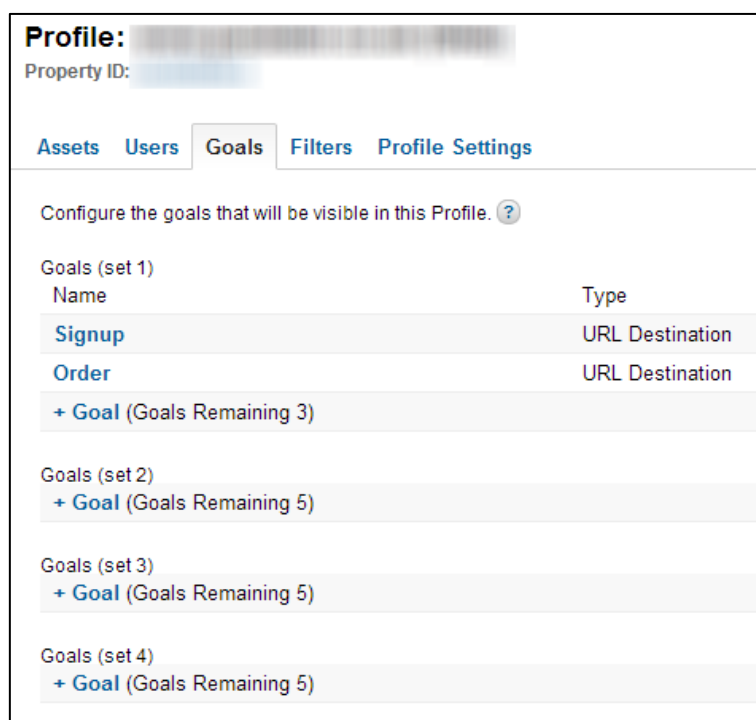
Here are a few examples of how to employ Goals to gain greater insight into how your site is used.

Page Visits: Tracking visits to a page as a goal can show you how your site is performing for aspects like email signups. Setting a goal up like this is quite straight forward. You won't need any sticky back plastic, just the URL of the "Thank You" or confirmation page.

First, follow this path:

Admin → Select profile → Goals

You should find yourself on this page:



The screenshot shows the Google Analytics Admin interface. At the top, it says "Profile:" followed by a blurred profile name and "Property ID:" followed by a blurred ID. Below this is a navigation bar with tabs: "Assets", "Users", "Goals" (which is selected), "Filters", and "Profile Settings". The main content area is titled "Configure the goals that will be visible in this Profile. ?". It lists four goal sets:

- Goals (set 1):

Name	Type
Signup	URL Destination
Order	URL Destination
+ Goal (Goals Remaining 3)	
- Goals (set 2):

+ Goal (Goals Remaining 5)	
----------------------------	--
- Goals (set 3):

+ Goal (Goals Remaining 5)	
----------------------------	--
- Goals (set 4):

+ Goal (Goals Remaining 5)	
----------------------------	--

As you can see we have a Goal labelled "Signup" so let's look at how that's configured.

To track a Signup we need to select the Goal Type as 'URL Destination' and then set the URL that we want to mark a visit to as a Goal Completion.

You don't need to add the whole URL here, simply add the URL path after the first /. For example, instead of using <http://www.mywebsite.com/thankyou> just use /thankyou.

Profile: [REDACTED]
Property ID: [REDACTED]

[Assets](#) [Users](#) [Goals](#) [Filters](#) [Profile Settings](#)

Goals ›
Goals (set 1): Goal 1

General Information

Goal Name

☒ Active ☐ Inactive

Goal Type ☒ URL Destination
☐ Visit Duration
☐ Page/Visit
☐ Event

Goal Details

Goal URL

e.g. For the goal page <http://www.mysite.com/thankyou.html> enter /thankyou.html. To help you verify that your goal URL is set up correctly, please see the [tips here](#).

Match Type

Case Sensitive ☐
URLs entered above must exactly match the capitalization of visited URLs.

Goal Value optional

There are 3 types of Match Types to choose from:

- Exact Match: this will track visits to the specified URL segment only, no variants
- Head Match: should your URL go down into a further folder eg; /signup/thankyou, you can configure the goal to trigger for visits to /signup/ and subsequent pages within the /signup folder
- Regular Expression Match: you can broaden triggers for the goal further by using Regular Expression codes to match a wider selection of URLs (see Glossary for more)

Finally, there is an optional Goal Value field that can be very useful to demonstrate the value of the Goal Completions. This can take the form of a monetary amount – if you know that on average 10% of Signups convert to a sale worth £100 you could set the Goal Value to £10. Or you can simply state a value of 1 to show how many goals were completed.

Interaction

If you run a site less centred on user action but more on how content is consumed, then you can set goals up to track how a user interacts with your site.

For instance a blog owner could measure how long visitors spend on the site or how many pages are visited on average per visit. Here are some ideas:

Visit Duration

You know that in the last 12 months the average visit to your site lasts 3 minutes. You might also think that people that stay on site longer than 3 minutes represent a real opportunity of some kind. You can set up a goal to trigger when a visit exceeds that.

Profile: PROPERTY ID: 1234567890

Property ID: 1234567890

[Assets](#) [Users](#) [Goals](#) [Filters](#) [Profile Settings](#)

Goals ›

Goals (set 1): Goal 3

General Information

Goal Name

☒ Active ☐ Inactive

Goal Type ☐ URL Destination ☒ Visit Duration ☐ Page/Visit ☐ Event

Goal Details

Visits with	Condition	Hours	Minutes	Seconds
<input checked="" type="button" value="Visit Duration"/>	Greater than ▼	0	3	
Goal Value optional				

You'll then be able to interrogate the data to see what keyword that visitor came to your site by and consider on site changes accordingly.

Pages Per Visit

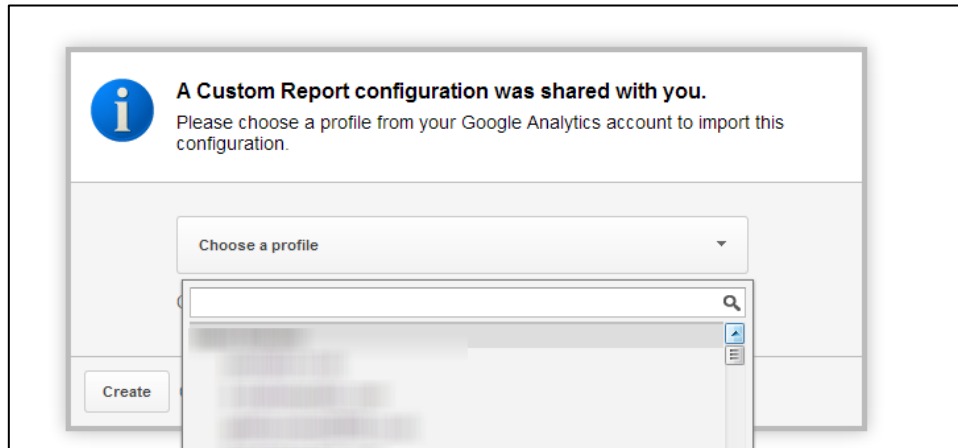
Instead of using time as a measure of site interaction, you can focus on content. Measuring this behaviour will pick up a user that is consuming more site content than the average visitor but not necessarily staying on site as long. This type of visitor could be equally as valuable and offer insights into the direction of the site.

Freebie

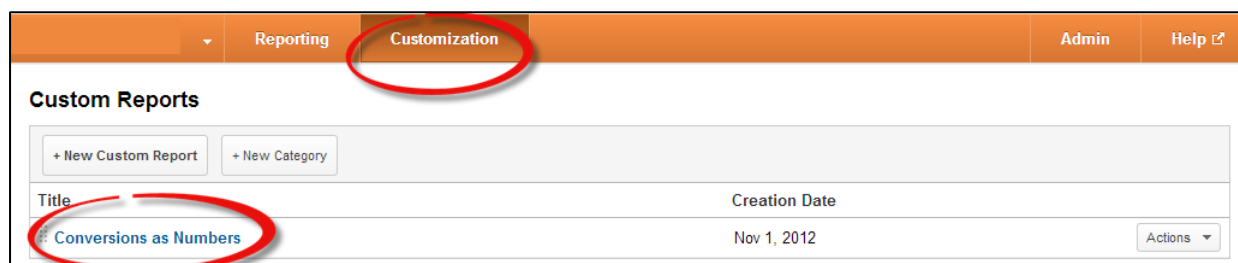
With this profile you can convert your conversions from percentages to actual numbers with this free Google Analytics Custom Report.

Click here: <https://www.google.com/analytics/web/template?uid=hDvQ2vUjQxuh3oIKf-kCdQ>

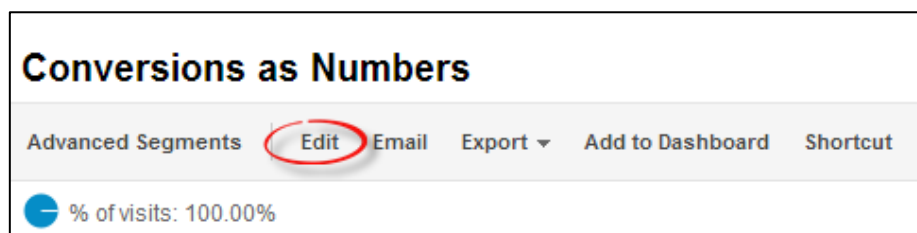
Then select the profile you want to add the report to:



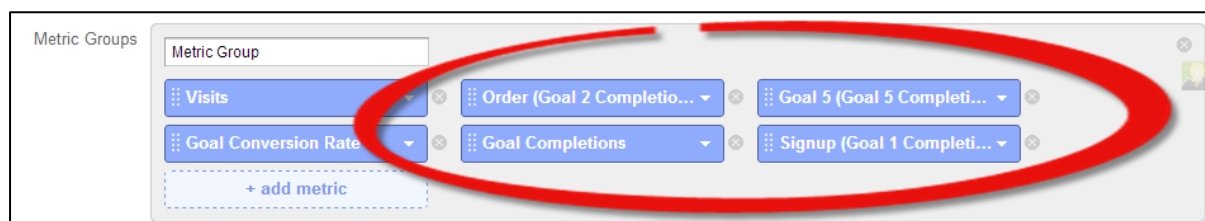
Once that's complete, open the report up by clicking on **Customization** and then **Conversions as numbers**.



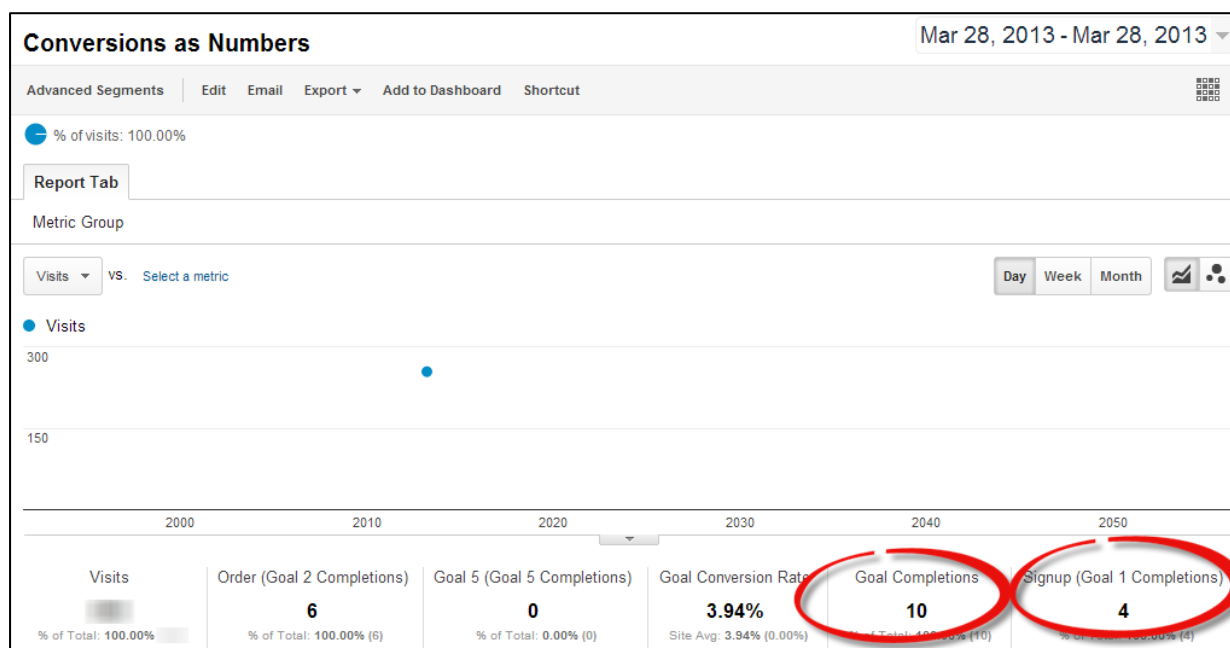
Now the report is open in front of you, make sure to edit the goals so that the right goals are being reported on.



This will open up the field you can customise the report with. The circled metrics are goal completions which are labelled **(Goal X Completions)**:



Once saved, you'll then have a report that looks a little like this:



From here the report will default to showing you data at **Medium** level. You can drill down though and view **Keyword** data too so if you click on **Organic** the table will populate with Keyword level conversion data.

Ecommerce

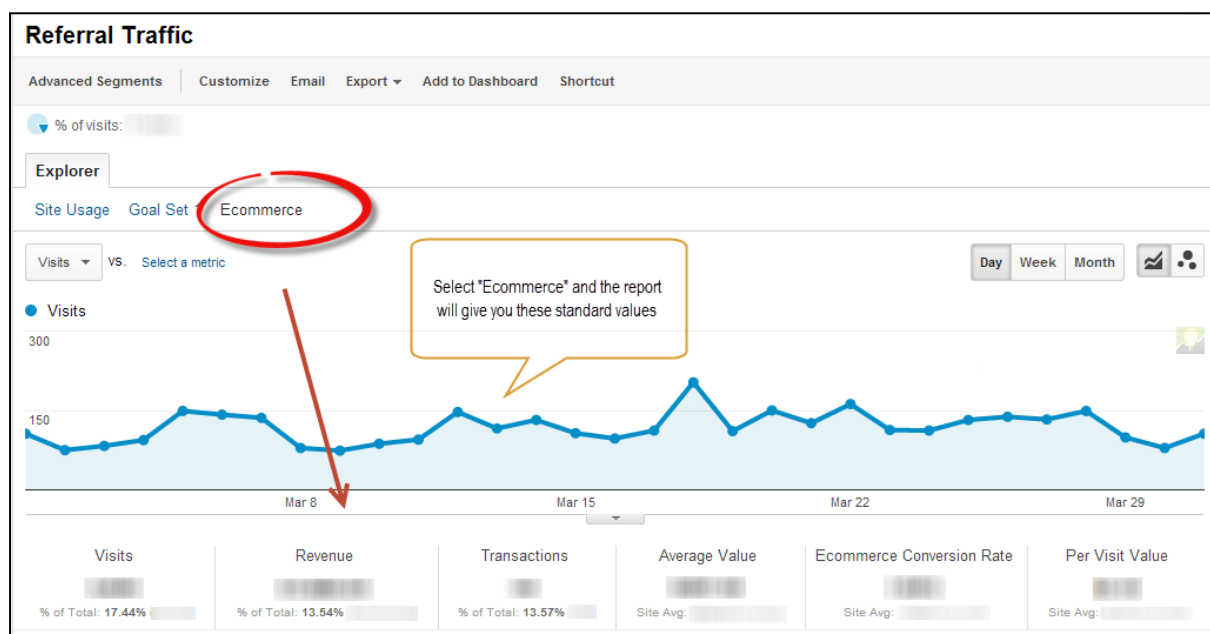
For websites which sell products online Ecommerce reporting is essential. It enables transactions to be attributed to specific marketing activity and pages of the site, helping you understand what is working and what can be improved in order to get better results.

Ecommerce tracking requires code to be added to the order confirmation page which pulls in the transaction information and enables it to be passed on to Google Analytics.

Once in place, Google Analytics will pull through product and sales performance metrics:

Sales	Products
Transactions	Product (name)
Quantity	Product SKU
Revenue	Product Category
Average Value	
Unique Purchases	
Ecommerce Conversion Rate	

Whilst it's intuitive to view the data from within the **Ecommerce Report** found under **Conversions**, it can be more beneficial to view ecommerce data from within a report that you have been analysing, for instance the **Referral** traffic report from your **Traffic Sources** menu.



So my steps here have been: Traffic Sources → Referrals → Ecommerce. The top level summary shows you:

- Visits – the total visits for Referral traffic in the period
- Revenue – the total Revenue generated by Referral traffic for the period
- Transactions – the total number of transactions completed in the period
- Average Value – the sum of Revenue divided by Transactions
- Ecommerce Conversion Rate – the sum of Transactions divided by Visits
- Per Visit Value – the sum of Revenue divided by visits

You can use the Primary Dimensions to drill the data down further such as Source, Landing Page and then other useful dimensions like City. If you go down this route you will need to select "Ecommerce" to get that top level information displayed again.

2. Custom & More Advanced Reports

By Anna Lewis

Now to delve deeper into the really exciting reports!

Some of these require additional code to collect the data and others are either less well known or just less used but we find them all very beneficial.

The reports covered in this section are:

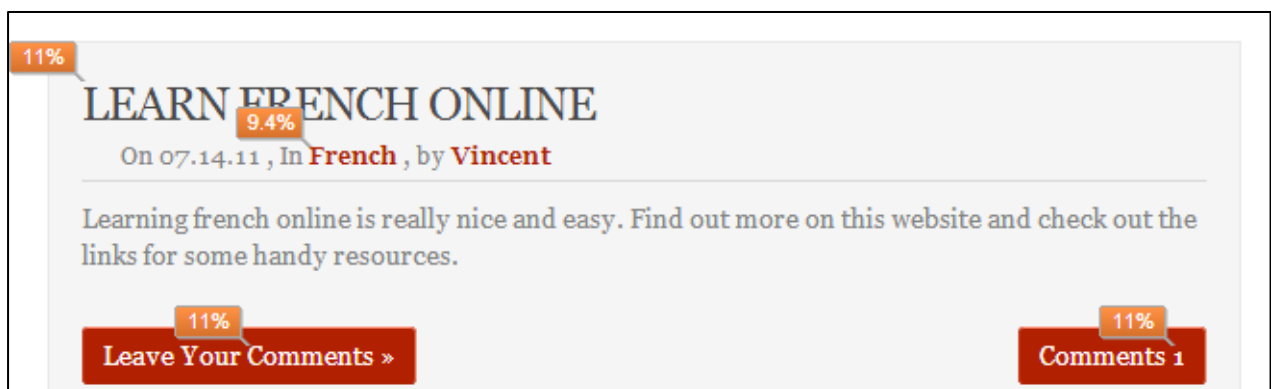
- In page analytics
- Social media
- Events
- Custom Variables
- Multi-Channel Funnels



In Page Analytics

Useful for: Web design, CRO and Content Analysis

This report is used to find out which internal links on the page are clicked the most, showing a percentage of the total alongside each link:



The data is calculated based on the next page (URI) that is visited, this means that by default Google Analytics cannot distinguish between multiple links to the same page and will group these together.

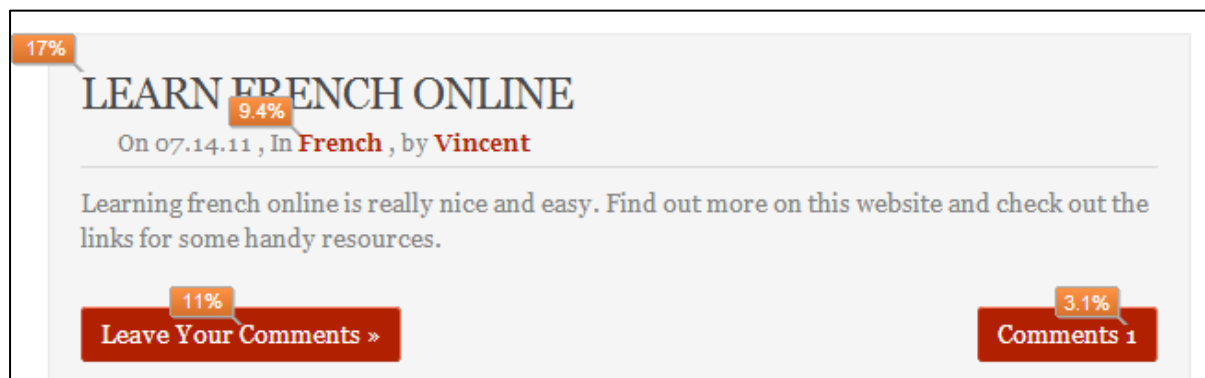
This can be seen in the example above by the three boxes which all state 11%, these have the same data as they all link through to the same URI.

Enhanced Link Attribution

To split the data apart for different links to the same page you will need to implement Enhanced Link Attribution.

This requires an additional line of code to be added to the standard Google Analytics tracking snippet and will need each different link on your pages to have a different ID in the code. Once this is in place you just tick the box in the Property Settings to enable the functionality. Here's the Google guide: <http://kooz.ai/ga-enhanced-links>

Once this is in place the results may then differ like so:



Don't forget to leave an annotation in GA to say when the code was edited.

Social Media

Useful for: Social management, Content marketing, SEO

The Social Media reports were introduced in March 2012 and have undergone several improvements since then. To find them it's:

Traffic Sources > Social

The data within this section is great for getting an understanding of activity on your website's social media buttons, where social traffic has come from and activity that has happened on other sites that Google has access to data for, called 'Data Hubs'.

The reports are broken down like so:

Network Referrals

This shows which social media platforms sent data to your site. Here Google Analytics pulls together all different referral sites for each platform to group them as one, i.e. Twitter is shown in the report; this traffic comes from twitter.com and t.co.

The report has data for the number of visits, the pageviews, average visit duration and pages per visit for each social platform that sent traffic to your website.

If you click the network name you will see the statistics broken down by which page of your site was shared.

Primary Dimension: Social Network					
Social Network	Visits	↓	Pageviews	Avg. Visit Duration	Pages / Visit
1. Twitter	2,279		3,223	00:01:58	1.41
2. Facebook	905		1,671	00:02:06	1.85
3. Google+ 	719		1,076	00:03:22	1.50
4. LinkedIn	369		560	00:02:54	1.52

The hub image (next to Google+) represents the social platforms that are Data Hubs, this signifies that there is more data available for these platforms.

Data Hub Activity

Data Hubs are the social platforms for which Google has full access to the data. This means Google Analytics can show you the conversations and shares that happened on these external sites.

It's useful for monitoring social media activity and identifying social trends surrounding your website.

Here's a snapshot of examples from the Koozai data. It shows the platform used (top left of avatar), who shared the content (with a link to their profile) and what was shared or discussed:

Viewing: Conversations Events			
Filter Pages Show rows: 10 Go to: 1 1 - 10 of 21			
	Koozai_Emma Mar 13, 2013 - 15:27	Google almost seems to have changed they're strategy recently. Instead of just rolling out periodic updates to refine the algorithm, they have started to tell us something major is on it's way, all at the same time as other major updates (Penguin, Panda, advertorials, etc.) Expand this comment » http://www.koozai.com/blog/search-marketing/creative-link-building-techniques-for-a-sustainable-link-b...	More ▾
	Anna Lewis Mar 13, 2013 - 14:17	Thanks Guys, I explained more about implementation in my blog post: http://www.koozai.com/blog/analytics/the-complete-google-analytics-event-tracking-guide-plus-10-amazing-examples/ Hopefully that will help! http://www.koozai.com/blog/analytics/the-complete-google-analytics-event-tracking-guide-plus-10-amaz...	More ▾
	Chris Simmance Mar 13, 2013 - 12:40	Great post today on the +koozai site by +Amanda DiSilvestro http://www.koozai.com/blog/social-media/google-ripples-how-to-make-them-work-for-you/ Great read. http://www.koozai.com/blog/social-media/google-ripples-how-to-make-them-work-for-you/	More ▾

Landing Pages

This report breaks down the social visits, pageviews, duration, data hub activities and pages per visit data for the pages of your site that have been shared on social platforms.

It's great for working out which pages have been successful on social media so you can make more like that.

Trackbacks

This report is all about the links to your site from other websites. It's very beneficial for identifying new sites linking to you and peaks in links being added (on the graph). For every link added the visit data is also shown.

Viewing: Conversations		
Filter Pages Show rows: 10 Go to: 1 1 - 10 of 84		
Endorsing URL ?	Your Page ?	Visits
 Using Google Analytics Quickly and Effectively http://www.seo-chicks.com/3274/using-google-analytics-quickly-... Mar 27, 2013 - 10:00	#BrightonSEO Quickfire Analytics – 7 Freebies in 7 Minutes http://www.koozai.com/blog/analytics/brightonseo-quickfire-analyt...	 More
 Clicks and Mortar – How to value a Website http://www.obfirst.org.uk/clicks-and-mortar-how-to-value-a-website/ Mar 27, 2013 - 09:51	How to Value a Website http://www.koozai.com/blog/branding/how-to-value-a-website/	 More
 Six Link Building Techniques that Really Matter http://blog.megawebmanager.com/six-link-building-techniques-th... Mar 26, 2013 - 10:18	How to Find Blogs for Guest Post Purposes http://www.koozai.com/blog/search-marketing/how-to-find-blogs-f...	 More

When this was introduced it highlighted even further how important links are to your website's performance, combining this with the visit data shows that Google would like to encourage website owners to be getting traffic from links on other websites.

Conversions

Simply put, this report shows you the quantity and value of conversions from social media sites. You can use this report to calculate the ROI from social media and identify which platforms outperform others.

If you are interested in attribution and how social media can help assist conversions that are attributed to other channels then you'll be interested in the Assisted vs. Last Interaction Analysis report too.

This shows you the quantity and value where social played a part in the journey and also the same data for the occasions when social media was the last interaction before the conversion. The Assisted / Last Interaction Conversions column shows which social platforms see more assists than lasts and vice versa.

The data below has had the social platform information removed but shows the data that you will see in this report. As you can see, the Assisted / Last Interaction Conversions

column is above one where there are more assists and below one when the source is more commonly a last interaction.

Assisted Conversions	↓	Assisted Conversion Value	Last Interaction Conversions	Last Interaction Conversion Value	Assisted / Last Interaction Conversions
66		£69.00	26	£26.00	2.54
25		£29.00	14	£49.00	1.79
21		£12.00	17	£24.00	1.24
12		£35.00	0	£0.00	∞
5		£5.00	13	£30.00	0.38
3		£1.00	3	£1.00	1.00
2		£2.00	15	£12.00	0.13

Plugins

This is where you find data relating to the social media buttons that have been used across your website. Google+ is tracked automatically but other buttons require additional tracking code in order to pass the data in to Google Analytics. Alternatively, some social button plugins will automatically track activity, as shown here:

This information can be used to work out which buttons should remain on the site and which ones do not see much activity.

Visitors Flow

This final social report shows where users navigated on site having come in through social platforms. The data is broken down by social platforms to help you identify trends from users coming from each platform.

The data in this report is sampled due to it being applied based on a segment of data, in this case social media traffic. This means that the data may not be accurate.

Additionally, when you have a large quantity of data it is harder to identify trends as users take so many different routes through websites. This report may be most beneficial for websites which have common journey paths through the site.

Event Tracking

Event tracking enables you to track user interactions on your site with a small amount of additional code. There are so many different things that you could be tracking to see what works for your users and what they don't interact with.

Event tracking can be used to make informed decisions about content, layout, features, performance and a whole lot more.

Have a look over the following ideas before going through your website and working out which elements it would be most beneficial to track. Don't try and track everything, it's best to track the items that will provide the most valuable data, namely those you know you will be able to analyse and improve on. Examples of data to collect through Event Tracking include:

Clicks on:

- PDFs
- Documents
- Download links
- Videos (more below)
- Form submission buttons
- Add to basket links
- Social sharing buttons
- Dropdown menus
- Sort / filter buttons
- Tabs (especially useful with AJAX, flash and HTML5 content)
- External Links
- Internal banners
- Rotating banner buttons
- Ads

Videos:

- Play
- Pause
- Stop
- Duration watched

Form interactions:

- Fields filled in
- % filled in
- Form errors
- Form drop outs

Other activity:

- Blog Comments
- Reviews added
- Live chat session starts
- % of page viewed
- Time on page

Additional Ecommerce information:

- Stock level
- Revenue lost due to no stock
- Discounts / Promotions
- Credit card failure
- Shipping country

Error tracking

- Track which error messages show
- Validation errors
- Voucher code fails

Games

- Which games played
- Level reached
- Scores
- Time in game
- Virtual money

Rank Tracking

- Search query
- Landing Page
- SERP position when clicked

These ideas above were generated during a discussion at MeasureCamp in London, March 2012. More information about them can be found here: <http://kooz.ai/measure-camp-ideas>

Event Tracking Set Up

Event tracking works by sending up to four custom pieces of information to Google Analytics, these are:

Category, Action, Label and Value

This information goes within code that sets when to fire the information such as when the item is clicked or after a certain length of time.

To use Event tracking on an item that is clicked the code would look something like:

```
onClick="_gaq.push(['_trackEvent', Category, 'Action', 'Label', 'Value']);"
```

Where the information you want to use is included for each field:

```
onClick="_gaq.push(['_trackEvent', 'whitepaper', 'download', 'SEO is great', '5']);"
```

Which would sit inside the link to the PDF download (in this example) like so:

```
<a href="/downloads/whitepapers/seo-is-great.pdf" onClick="_gaq.push(['_trackEvent', 'whitepaper', 'download', 'SEO is great', '5']);" target="_blank">SEO Is Great Whitepaper</a>
```

When using Event Tracking on a website, you will need to be aware that Events will impact the bounce rate of the page. This is because, by default, Events count as an interaction in the same way as visiting another page does meaning that visits that trigger Events will not be a bounce even if only one page was visited.

If you need to prevent Event Tracking counting as a bounce then just add true to the end of the string:

```
onClick="_gaq.push(['_trackEvent', 'whitepaper', 'download', 'SEO is great', '5', true]);"
```

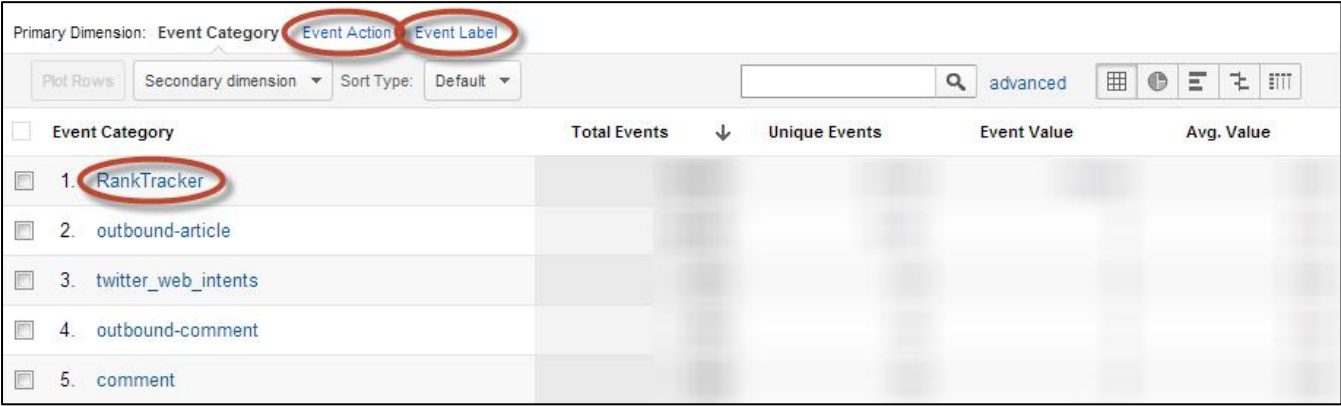
This sets the optional non-interaction field to prevent the Event counting towards the bounce rate.

Event Tracking Reports

Now for the fun bit – the data!

Head over to **Content > Events > Top Events**

Event tracking reports are organised with reports for Categories, Actions and Labels, allowing you to either review all data within one dimension in one place or to click through to a specific Event and see the additional information for it there:



Primary Dimension: Event Category				
Plot Rows: Secondary dimension Sort Type: Default				
Event Category	Total Events	Unique Events	Event Value	Avg. Value
1. RankTracker				
2. outbound-article				
3. twitter_web_intents				
4. outbound-comment				
5. comment				

It's important to bear the structure of this report in mind when naming your Event tracking elements. Having a good Event tracking structure is essential for easy analysis, if you can't segment the data how you need to you might miss actionable insights.

For more information about setting up Event Tracking please see this comprehensive guide which covers the implementation for a wide range of uses:

<http://kooz.ai/event-tracking-guide>

Custom Variables

By adding a line of code to the snippet you can add **custom metrics** to your Google Analytics account in order to collect additional data for advanced measurement and filtering.

Custom variables can either be set based on the page, session or visitor meaning there are many different ways they can be used.

Examples of uses of Custom Variables include:

Visitor level:

- Demographic information (gender, age, actual location)
- Member level
- User type (level of membership or categorisation based on previous activity)

Session level:

- User type (e.g. logged in or guest, some overlap with visitor level variables)
- Whether the user is using the navigation or the internal search

Page level:

- Blog post author
- Product name, brand, category, price range
- Page type (Category, offer, value)
- Which version of an experiment is shown
- Orientation of tablet or phone

The code required (showing explanatory comments) is:

```
_gaq.push(['_setCustomVar',  
  1,           // This custom var is set to slot #1. Required.  
  'Member Type', // The name of the custom variable. Required.  
  'Premium',    // The value of the custom variable. Required.  
  1           // Sets the scope to visitor-level. Optional.  
]);
```

Which would be incorporated in to the snippet like so (highlighted yellow):

```
<script type="text/javascript">
```

```
var _gaq = _gaq || [];  
_gaq.push(['_setAccount', 'UA-XXXXX-X']);  
_gaq.push(['_setCustomVar', 1, 'Member Type', 'Premium', 1]);  
_gaq.push(['_trackPageview']);
```

```
(function() {  
  var ga = document.createElement('script'); ga.type = 'text/javascript'; ga.async = true;  
  ga.src = ('https:' == document.location.protocol ? 'https://ssl' : 'http://www') + '.google-  
analytics.com/ga.js';  
  var s = document.getElementsByTagName('script')[0]; s.parentNode.insertBefore(ga, s);  
})();
```

```
</script>
```

Reporting on Custom Variables

The data is then found under **Audience > Custom > Custom variables**

It is broken down in to five reports, one for each of the five 'slots' available, as specified by the first number in the code.

Let me take you through one of my favourite examples:

Blog Author Custom Variables

On the Koozai site we have a blog with over 20 regular authors and weekly guest authors. In order to evaluate how well author's blog posts perform you can put custom variables on every blog post which collect the author name. The code looks like so:

```
_gaq.push(['_setCustomVar',2,'author','anna-lewis',3]);
```

This means the data will be in slot 2, this slot information is called 'author', the author of the page this code is on is Anna Lewis and the number 3 at the end means it is a page level custom variable.

In the reports we have navigated to Key 02:

Primary Dimension: Custom Variable (Key 1) Custom Variable (Key 2)

Plot Rows Secondary dimension Sort Type: Default

☐ Custom Variable (Key 2)

☒ 1. author

To see the data collected within this you then click the link for 'author' and see a breakdown of all author's statistics, I've hidden all the data but left the author name from this code visible for you to see:

Primary Dimension: Custom Variable (Value 02) Other						
Plot Rows Secondary dimension Sort Type: Default						
Custom Variable (Value 02)						
	Visits	Pages / Visit	Avg. Visit Duration	% New Visits	Bounce Rate	
1. anna-lewis	25,185	11.21	00:01:01	82.88%	28.18%	
2. anna-lewis	25,185	11.21	00:01:01	78.73%	78.88%	
3. anna-lewis	12,185	22.21	00:01:07	28.88%	42.18%	
4. anna-lewis	18,185	22.21	00:01:01	82.73%	77.88%	
5. anna-lewis	77,885	11.21	00:01:01	82.88%	78.18%	

Multi-Channel Funnels

This report is one of the most complex in Google Analytics but it can provide some very valuable data. Its purpose is to identify which common routes users take to get to your site through different channels before they convert. This information helps you identify channels which do not get many conversions attributed to them through the standard method but do contribute through a user's journey so should not be discounted.

Understanding attribution

Before using Multi-Channel Funnels it is important to understand that Google Analytics uses last interaction conversion attribution. This means that in Google Analytics the final channel that the user used to get to your site is shown as the one that generated the conversion – unless the final channel was direct, in which case the conversion is attributed to the previous channel.

This table shows the attributions that are reported for various different journey combinations:

First Visit	Second Visit	Third Visit (Conversion to Goal)	Which Medium Reported?
CPC	Organic	Referral	Referral
CPC	Organic	CPC	CPC
CPC	Organic	Direct	Organic
Organic	CPC	Referral	Referral
Organic	CPC	CPC	CPC
Organic	CPC	Direct	CPC
Direct	CPC	Referral	Referral
Direct	CPC	CPC	CPC
Direct	CPC	Direct	CPC
Direct	Organic	Direct	Organic

Multi-Channel Funnel Reports

This data takes in to account a visitors activity 30 days prior to converting (assuming they haven't deleted their cookies, switched browser or device).

Assisted Conversions

This report breaks down the assisted and last conversions total and value by channel so that you can identify channels which see more assists than last interactions:

Primary Dimension: Basic Channel Grouping Source / Medium Source Medium Other Channel Groupings						
Plot Rows Secondary dimension				advanced		
Basic Channel Grouping	Assisted Conversions	Assisted Conversion Value	Last Interaction Conversions	Last Interaction Conversion Value	Assisted / Last Interaction Conversions	
1. Direct	118	£212.00	311	£613.00	0.38	
2. Organic Search	103	£250.00	287	£822.00	0.36	
3. Social Network	65	£95.00	99	£124.00	0.66	
4. Referral	40	£64.00	69	£132.00	0.58	

As you can see from the links above this report you can break the data down through other dimensions too as well as applying secondary dimensions for more in depth analysis.

This report gives you the straightforward numbers for each channel, which is great for proving their worth. If you want to see more information about the journeys users took through different channels you're going to be more interested in the next report:

Top Conversion Paths

This report is here to show you the common routes that your visitors took to get to the site before converting. There are some great standard reports that can help you identify trends but there is also good scope for customising this data to show the paths in a way that means the most to you through Custom Channel Groupings.

Custom Channel Groupings

By editing or creating your own Channel Groupings you can see data in the way that makes sense to your business and marketing strategies. Standard Channel Groupings include organic, referral, paid etc. These are explained by Google here:

<http://support.google.com/analytics/answer/1191184> with this table:

Channel	Description
Display	Interactions with a medium of "display", or "cpm". Also includes AdWords interactions with ad distribution network set to "content" but excluding ad format of "text".
Paid Search	Visits from the AdWords Search Network or other search engines, with a medium of "cpc" or "ppc".
Other Advertising	Visits that are tagged with a medium of "cpc", "ppc", "cpm", "cpv", "cpa", "cpp", "content-text", "affiliate" (excluding Paid Search).

Organic Search	Visits from unpaid search on any search engine (i.e. medium="organic").
Social	Visits from any of approximately 400 social networks (that are not tagged as ads).
Referral	Visits from websites that are not social networks.
Email	Visits that are tagged with a medium of "email".
Direct	Visits in which the visitor typed the name of your website URL into the browser or who came to your site via a bookmark (i.e., source="(direct)" and medium="(not set)" or "(none)").

Customising them allows you to break down brand organic, non brand organic, display advertising, individual campaigns, social media, link building, affiliates and anything else you can think of.

Personally, we wouldn't use Multi Channel Funnels without using Custom Channel Groupings.

To set them up you can either start from scratch or use the basic template and edit it:



If it's your first time using Custom Channel Groupings we recommend copying the basic Channel Grouping template first and having a play with this to get used to it before starting from scratch.

Choose the purpose of your Custom Channel and then create a rule for each different channel, label these clearly so that it's easy for anyone to interpret the data. Each rule is set up in a similar way to advanced segments, you specify the dimensions you want to break it down by and set what they should match.

It's beneficial to have an understanding of Regular Expressions when setting this up and they can save you a lot of time.

You also pick a colour for each channel; we like to give similar channels similar colours to make the report easy to spot trends on.



Ideas for Custom Channel Groupings include:

- PPC keyword match types
- Link building analysis (to separate which referral traffic is gained naturally or through link building)
- Brand vs. Non Brand
- Keyword types (generic vs. longtail)
- Keyword category (shoes vs. dresses)

Some good resources for getting more from Multi Channel Funnels are:

- <http://online-behavior.com/analytics/multi-channel-funnels>
- <http://www.ppchero.com/ultimate-guide-to-googles-multi-channel-funnels/>
- <http://www.koozai.com/blog/analytics/introduction-to-multi-channel-funnels/>
- <http://www.koozai.com/blog/analytics/making-money-with-multi-channel-funnels-from-think-visibility/>

3. Customising and Segmenting Reports

By Anna Lewis

Google Analytics reports are great, but do they always give you exactly what you're looking for?

This section is going to cover how to customise the reports and tweak things to get exactly what you're looking for. The tips covered here will really take your Google Analytics to the next level! From custom reports that show exactly what you want, to segmenting the data to break it down and compare results in much more detail!



We will cover:

- Advanced Segments *To break down data in to more detail*
- Custom Reports *Looks like a standard report but has everything you've chosen*
- Dashboards *A page with 10 widgets showing just the data you choose*
- Short Cuts *Quick ways to get to your favourite reports!*
- Alerts *Set up email alerts for data changes to save you checking*
- Real Time *See how many people are on site right now*
- Campaign tracking *Get useful traffic source data for your campaigns*

Advanced Segments

Google Analytics has a nifty little feature called Advanced Segments that, simply put, allows you to group your data based on a wide variety of factors. By grouping the data you can analyse different segments more closely. We would definitely not recommend skipping this section – Advanced Segments are hugely beneficial for troubleshooting and comparing performance.

I'm going to take you through the kinds of segments you can use and how to get the most out of these advanced segments. There is so much scope with advanced segments that if you haven't used them before you will hopefully be brimming with ideas by the time you've read this section.

The following methods are very useful examples of segments you can look at:

Default Segments (already set up for you)

- Visits from paid traffic
- Visits direct to your site
- New visitors only
- Visits that did not bounce
- Visits with conversions
- Traffic from mobile devices

Custom Segments

- Visits landing on a specific page
- Visits via target keywords
- Visits from Twitter
- Visits from all social media
- Visits on specific browsers
- Visitor location
- Tracking custom URL sources (having built campaign urls here)
- Search term used on site

Combining Segments

One segment alone can't always tell the whole story, so it's very beneficial to also combine a number of segments to narrow your data down further and to compare against different segments, for example:

- Visit source + Landing Page
- Non paid search + Keyword contains core term + Goal Completed
- Target Keyword + Goal not completed
- A group of referring sites
- Mobile visits + Social Media visits
- Viewed specific page + Spent X minutes on site
- Location + Conversions

Or you could combine a number of factors to see a very specific segment, for example:

- Non paid search + Keyword contains core term + Goal Completed

What to look for using Advanced Segments

This would then allow you to see useful information about different types of users, including the volume, interaction, conversions and pages viewed. Once you know how different users interact with the site you can then optimise the website based on what you've learnt works for those that convert.

It's also very beneficial to compared segments against each other for certain data, for example:

- PPC Vs SEO
- One referring site Vs Another referring site
- One keyword Vs Another keyword
- One browser Vs Another browser

What to do with Advanced Segment Data?

Taking this further, here are some examples of the kinds of data you can find to influence your website decisions:

What percentage of your visits are on mobiles? Do you need a mobile site?

What percentage of mobile visits are compatible with apps? Could you increase mobile profit by creating an app?

Do visitors on one particular browser interact differently to another browser? Should you test browser compatibility more thoroughly?

Which keyword groups see a higher bounce rate on target pages? Do you need to optimise the content?

Which of your custom campaign URLs is performing better as a landing page? How can you optimise for better performance?

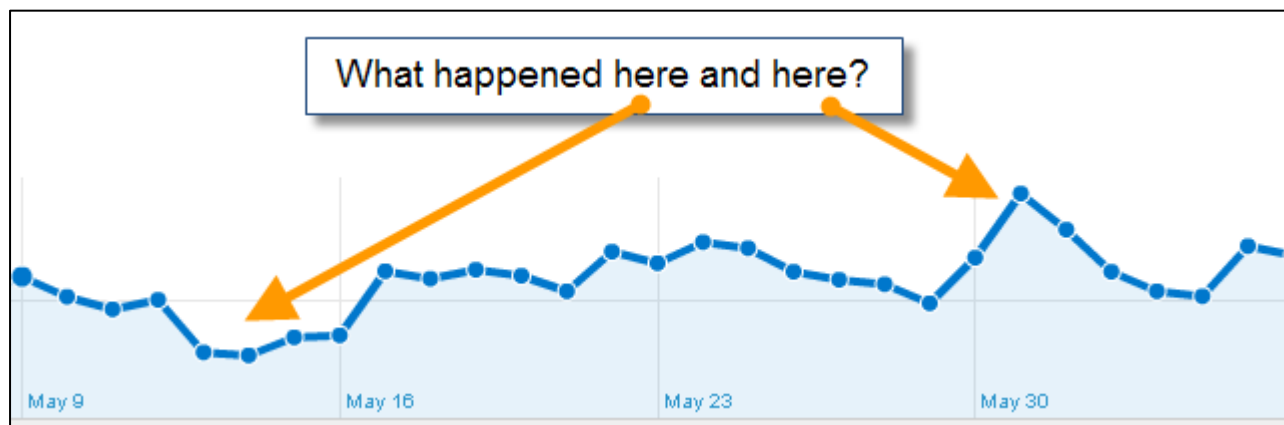
Advanced Segments for Error Handling

Another good use of segments is to see data when errors have happened in your account. Use this post to [check for errors in Google Analytics](#) and then you may need to use the following:

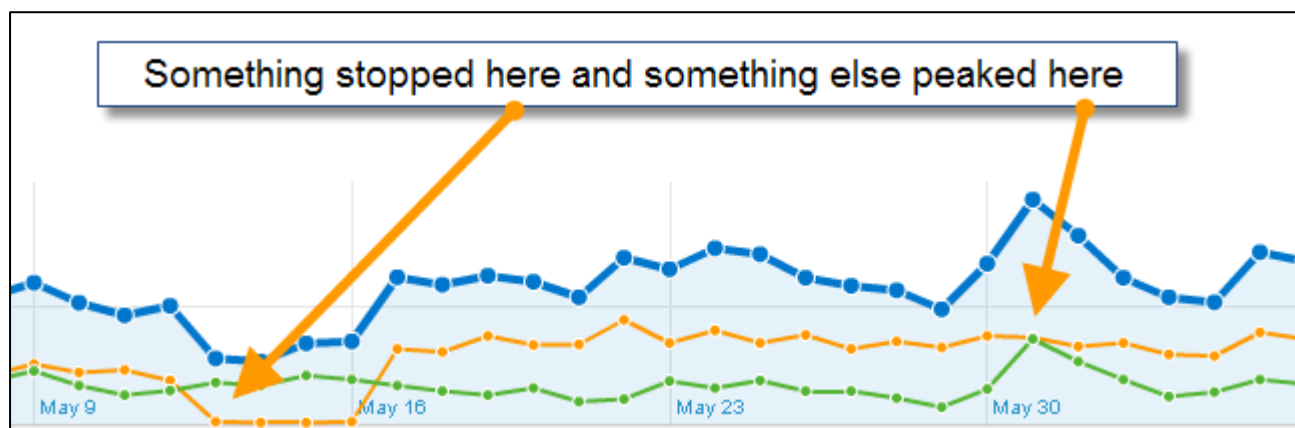
- Segment by hostname if more than one domain has your code
- Segment by internal referral

Most Common Use of Advanced Segments

If you don't use any of the ideas above, the least you can do is [try this one](#). It's my most frequently used Advanced Segment and shows which segment on the graph goes up and which goes down:



Find out using Advanced Segments:



This shows how useful they are on a day to day basis, as well as being essential for in depth analysis.

Top Advanced Segments

The following section on Advanced Segments is taken from a blog post we wrote which covered examples of Advanced Segments to help you get the most from them. To implement these just click the link and select which profile to apply it to.

Mobile Traffic Excluding Tablets

It's useful to know how many people visiting your site are on their mobile phones and how many are using tablets. This helps you ascertain just how important it is to have mobile and tablet friendly sites and work out how performance and conversions differ across the devices.

This has been made slightly harder by an update at the end of May that grouped iPad and iPhone traffic in to one group: Operating System = iOS. Phone and tablet performance are very different and websites behave very differently so it's good to separate these. I've looked at the screen resolution of iPads in Google Analytics and excluded them from this segment, meaning it should only show you mobile traffic, excluding tablets:

- [Mobile Traffic by Operating System \(Excludes tablets\)](#)

Keyword Length

Knowing what type of keywords are bringing the most traffic, the best interactions and the best conversion rate on your site is really insightful. We like to use the following four segments at the same time to compare the different keyword lengths alongside each other. Hat tip to [Avinash Kaushik](#) for providing the code for these on his blog.

- [1 Word Keywords](#)
- [2 Word keywords](#)
- [3 Word keywords](#)
- [4+ word keywords](#)

Not Provided

Losing keyword data has been a challenge for most Analytics users. There are ways to get round it, by looking at landing pages and guessing or by using Webmaster Tools data but the first thing I'd recommend doing when you want to see the impact of the lost data is to use these two segments:

- [All \(not provided\) data](#)
- [Excludes not provided data](#)

Compare the two against each other to see whether they contain keywords you don't know are actually valuable to your business, then think about using the other methods of analysis. Remember to check the content report, conversion report and even the audience information in order to understand the difference between these two types of users.

And think of it as a free custom variable from Google, telling you which of your users are logged in to Google's services when coming to your site.

Converting Traffic Source Analysis

We all like to know where conversions have come from – how else can we increase the amount otherwise?! So here are some advanced segments that look at the converting visits from specific traffic sources:

- [Organic visits with Conversions/Transactions](#)
- [Social media visit with conversion](#)

For this social media traffic segment we have used the following regular expression match to catch the majority of social sites that send traffic:

```
facebook\.com|twitter\.com|linkedin|del\.icio\.us|delicious\.com|technorati|digg\.com|  
hootsuite|stumbleupon|netvibes|bloglines|faves\.com|aim\.com|friendfeed|blinklist|fark|furl|newsgat  
or|prweb|msplinks|myspace|bit\.ly|tr\.im|cli\.gs|zi\.ma|popr|tinyurl|ow\.ly|reddit|plus\.url\.google\.c  
om|t\.co|m\.facebook\.com|tweetdeck|youtube|ycombinator|flickr|popurls|myspace|pinterest\.com
```

- [All social media traffic](#)

On Page Interaction Segments

Analysing on page interaction can really help you understand how users get on with your site and where you could make improvements to increase interactivity, user experience and conversions. Here are four segments that use on page interaction metrics:

- [Social media visit over 5 pages viewed](#)
- [Non bounce social media traffic](#)
- [Non bounce organic traffic](#)
- [Non bounce PPC traffic](#)

Extra Bonus Advanced Segments

Here are some traffic segments you might want to consider creating, depending on what makes a difference on your website:

- [Google+ Traffic](#) (yes there might be some!!)
- [Y Combinator traffic](#)
- Email campaign traffic (group bad labelling)
- Paid listings you have with sites like yell.com
- Segment for target keywords
- Desktop PC users – compare to phones – compare to tablets
- Segment by subdomain / sub folder
- Views of a particular page
- Views of a particular page from a specific location (to highlight unnatural traffic)

The list of possible advanced segments you could use is endless, so you will have to decide what is most valuable to you.

Also, it is very important to use the data wisely; try and compare the data to another segment so you can judge performance against something else and make informed decisions about your most successful activities.

Custom Reports

One simple way to make Google Analytics easy to use, in order to get the best data for what you need, is to set up a few custom reports with the data that you want. These can then be set up to show on dashboards or as a shortcut report, so that all your key numbers are easily accessible and actionable.

Here we will explain how to set up custom reports and cover examples that will help you understand your visitors and conversions more than the standard reports available. I've also included a number of reports that you can access without having to set them up yourself.

The simple way to set Custom Reports up is to click the 'Customize' button on a standard reports. This then takes the standard information and sets up a custom report which allows

you to modify it from there. It is faster and easier to get to grips with than starting from scratch, but here is the full process from beginning to end which will also help you use the quick method once you know how Custom Reports work.

Head over to the 'Customization' tab and click +New Custom Report:

From here follow these steps, outlined below and shown in the image:

1. Name your new report
2. Name the data tab, standard reports only have one tab which is shown above the graph
3. Choose which type of report you want, I'd recommend choosing Explorer as this allows for better data manipulation

General Information

Report Name

Report Content

Keyword Analysis

Name

Type

4. You can have numerous metric groups, these are selected directly above the graph in the report and are useful for grouping the metrics you want to compare

5. Choose which metrics you want to show, here I've created a group for interaction and conversion statistics

6. You can add a number of metric groups so don't try and fit it all in one

Metric Groups

Interaction

Visits Unique Visitors Bounce Rate

Bounces % Exit + add metric

Conversions

Visits Purchase (Old Site) (Go...) Purchase (Old Site) (Go...)

Goal 2 (Goal2 Completi... Goal 2 (Goal2 Conversi... + add metric

+ Add metric group

7. This is what you measure the statistics against, in this example we want to break it down by keywords, source and then landing page

8. Here you can apply a filter, I've set this to only include organic results

9. Select which profiles you want this report to show, this makes it easy to create a template and apply it to a number of profiles but do bear in mind that many will use different goals / conversions

The screenshot displays a reporting interface with three main sections:

- Dimension Drilldowns:** Contains three dropdown menus labeled 'Keyword', 'Source', and 'Landing Page'. A red arrow labeled '7' points to the 'Keyword' dropdown.
- Filters - optional:** Includes an 'Include' dropdown set to 'Medium', an 'Exact' dropdown, and a text input field containing 'organic'. A red arrow labeled '8' points to the 'organic' input field.
- Profiles - optional:** Shows a 'Current Profile' field and an 'Additional Profiles' dropdown set to '2 other profiles'. A red arrow labeled '9' points to the 'Additional Profiles' dropdown.

10. Save!

Now that you know how to build a report you can start thinking about the sorts of data that you want to analyse. Here are some suggestions and I've even included a number of templates for reports that I've created or seen elsewhere:

- Visitor interaction – what matters to you?
- Landing page report – which pages have the most impact and which need work?
- [Organic Keyword performance](#) (shown above)
- [Conversions by time of day](#)
- [Goals by pages](#)
- [Long Tail Traffic](#)
- [Page Efficiency Analysis Report](#) (by Avinash Kaushik)
- [Simple Referring Sites Data](#)
- [Paid Search Analytics Ecosystem](#) (by Avinash Kaushik)

You can also create different reports for reporting to different people. Think about minimising the detail in reports for people who only need top level information, so as not to distract them from the bigger picture. Or you could set up filtered reports for people who work on specific marketing channels such as email marketing or PPC.

Alerts, Dashboards, Shortcut Reports and Keyword Shortcuts

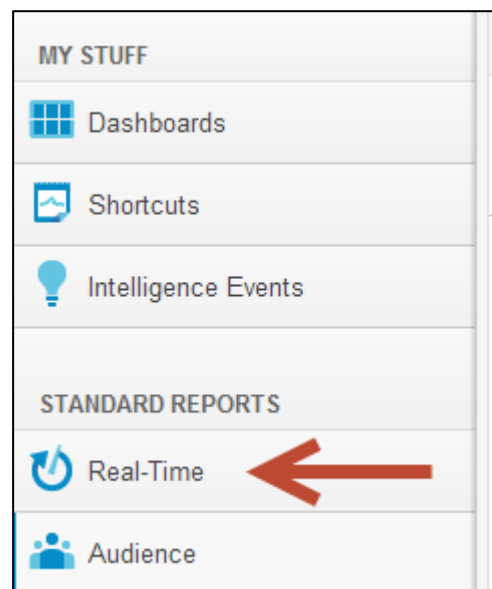
These four items are great functionality that make Google Analytics quicker and easier to use, they also help you stay on top of your data and any changes without having to take ages to check it regularly.

I've written them all up in one handy post over on SEO Chicks, check out the post for the detailed information about them:

<http://www.seo-chicks.com/3274/using-google-analytics-quickly-and-effectively.html>

Real Time

Real Time reports is an exciting place to see how many people are on your site right now. To see the data go to the Reporting tab and it is the first Standard Report on the left hand side:



What can the Real Time Report be used for?

Here are some ideas:

- See instant progress of social media shares
- Track the take up of email promotions
- Check it's ok to make an update to your site
- Follow the volume of traffic from new links
- See which pages are busiest right now
- Check if tracking code updates are working

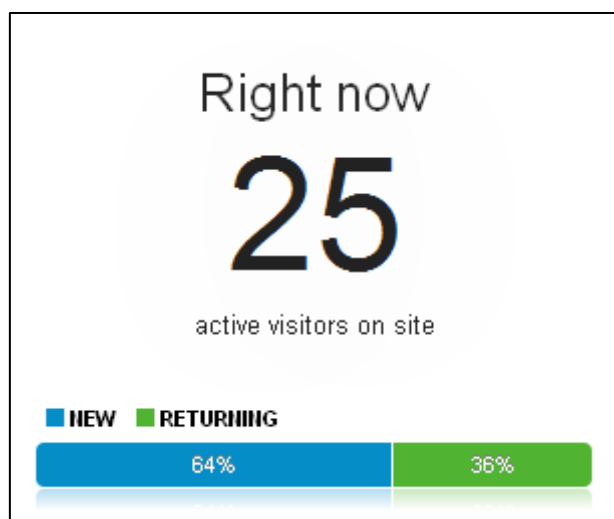
In addition to these normal ideas, there is also the possibility that you can take visitor stalking to the next level. Imagine trying to second guess which page a user is looking at when they have phoned you up? This sounds spooky but could be beneficial to both you and

them as you will be able to understand what they're looking for/at more easily and help them more as a result.

It may also help you gain more accurate search term lead data if you've been using the 'ask the caller how they found you' method of lead tracking, as you can now find which traffic source most closely matches what they say they did.

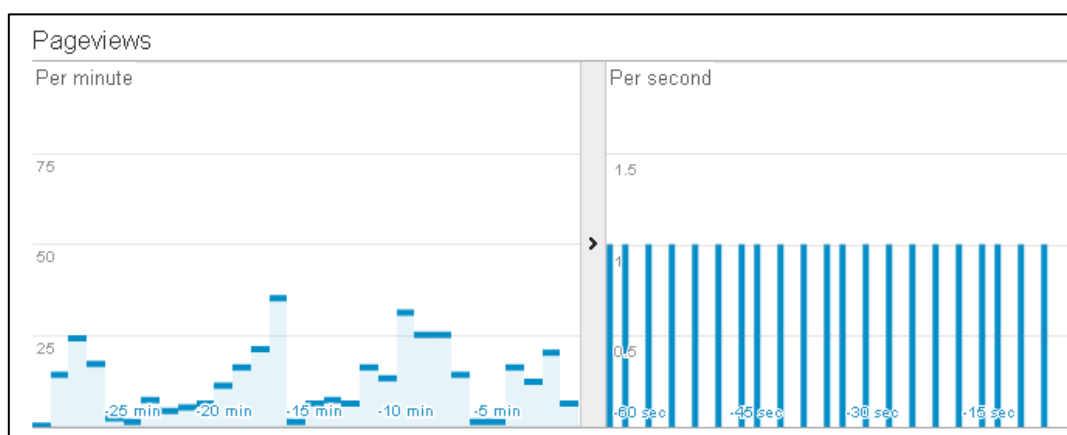
Here are some screen shots and information about what the data shows you.

Overview:



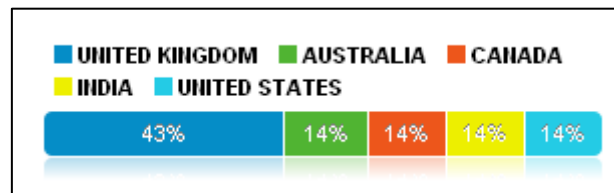
This shows how many new and returning visitors there are on your site right now, which can be useful if you've sent something out and what to see how many new people are looking compared to how many people who have been on your site before.

Within the Overview you can also see the top referrals, keywords, locations and pages, as well as graphs showing when people have come to your site in the last 60 seconds and 30 minutes.

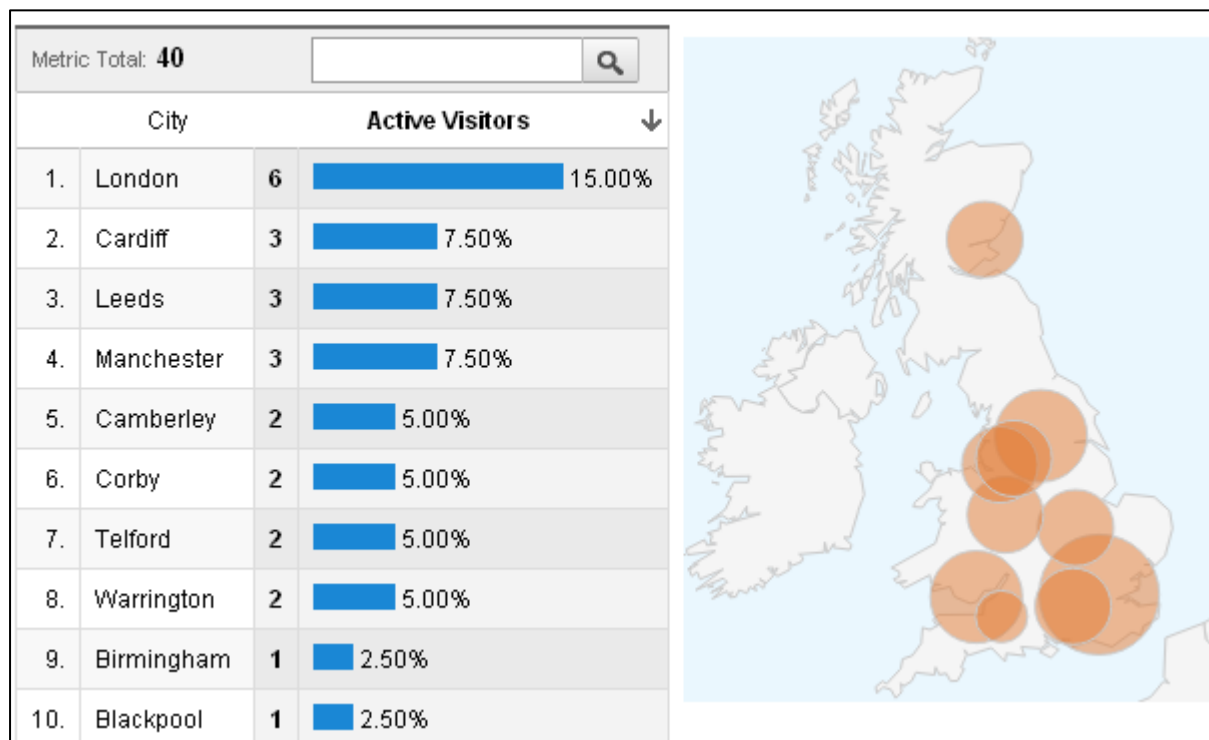


Locations

Under locations you can see where in the world people are accessing your site from at that very moment.



You can also see a map of where your users are, with larger blobs representing more visitors:



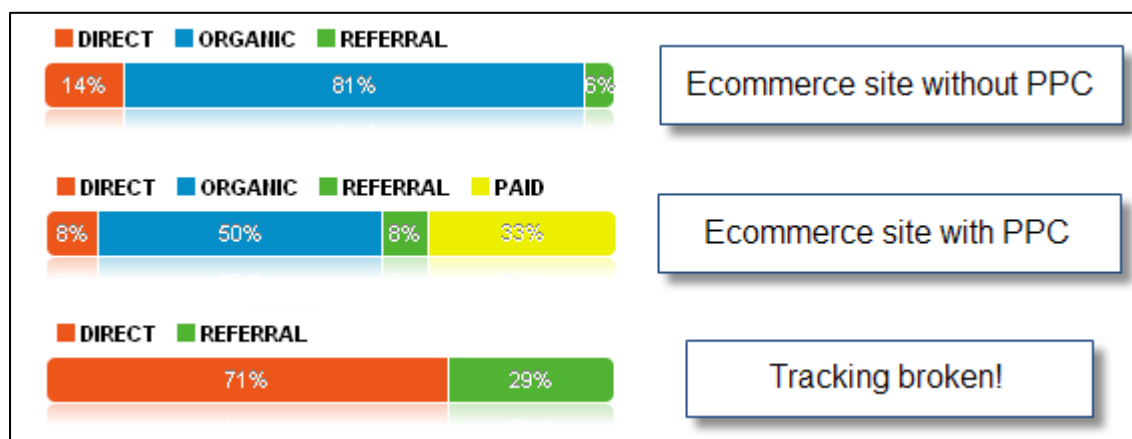
By adding a plugin you should be able to see a Google Earth representation of where your users are, however we have never managed to get this to work!

Traffic Sources

Here we can see where people have come from to get to the site, this is most valuable when you promote content on your site through social media or an email which is likely to be viewed once promoted.

Metric Total: 15					
	Medium	Source	Active Visitors		
1.	feed	feedburner	9		60.00%
2.	Referral	t.co	3		20.00%
3.	Organic	google	2		13.33%
4.	Organic	bing	1		6.67%

As we have access to a number of analytics profiles, here are some examples of the variations you could see across different types of websites at any given moment:



Content

This area highlights which pages your users are on now, which is good when you've just promoted a page with a tweet or email:

Top Active Pages:			
	Active Page	Active Visitors	
1.	/blog/fun-games/koozai-do-movember-day-one-movembe...	9	56.25%
2.	/blog/fun-games/koozai-do-movember-day-one-movembe...	3	18.75%
3.	/blog/internet-news/online-shopping-trends-for-201...	1	6.25%
4.	/blog/search-engine-optimisation-seo/link-building...	1	6.25%
5.	/blog/search-marketing/seo-vs-ppc-which-is-more-ef...	1	6.25%
6.	/sem-work/portfolio.htm	1	6.25%

Campaign Tracking

When you run advertising campaigns or send emails out to your customers you're going to want to know how well these perform alongside your other traffic. To see this data nicely organised in the traffic reports you need to use campaign tracking URLs.

Below we explain how to set up campaign tracking for email campaigns which should help you get up to speed with how to manage this functionality for any external campaigns that you run.

Remember not to use this method internally on the site as it will prevent the activity matching up with the external traffic data.

Tracking Email Campaigns

When looking at the Traffic Report in Google Analytics once an email campaign has been sent it can be hard to get a good understanding of how much traffic came to the site and how these visitors interacted and converted.

Unfortunately, Google can't track this automatically for you as there are so many email providers but luckily it's nice and easy to implement tracking yourself so that you can see exactly how many visits were generated from each email campaign and how these visitors interacted with your site.

What you need to do is add a string of tracking code to each link to your website within your email, but don't worry, this code is used in the link reference rather than being visible to the users. To generate the tracking code use this [Campaign URL Builder](#) from Google.

Firstly, enter the URL you want to track:

Step 1: Enter the URL of your website.

Website URL: *

(e.g. <http://www.urchin.com/download.html>)

Secondly, choose how you want to see the data reported in Analytics by specifying the Campaign Source, Medium and Name:

The Campaign **Medium** is the overarching category and includes organic, cpc and referral as standard so we would recommend using 'email' for your email campaign.

Source is the next level down and can be more specific, here we would recommend using something like 'summer newsletter' or 'red widget promotion'.

The **Name** can be as specific as you like, you could use a top level categorisation or you might even want to go as far as labelling each link differently, ie 'header offer', 'specific blog post' or 'job ad 1'.

You can also use the extra fields depending on how much you want to track. I'd recommend having a look in Google Analytics and working out what kind of information you want to appear in each report, this will help you see what sort of label would work best for each area.

Step 2: Fill in the fields below. **Campaign Source**, **Campaign Medium** and **Campaign Name** should always be used.

Campaign Source: *	July Newsletter	(referrer: google, citysearch, newsletter4)
Campaign Medium: *	email	(marketing medium: cpc, banner, email)
Campaign Term:		(identify the paid keywords)
Campaign Content:		(use to differentiate ads)
Campaign Name*:	Blog Example Link	(product, promo code, or slogan)

Step 3

4. How to set up Google Analytics for your business

By Anna Lewis

Now that you know how to find the data, we're going to take you through the set up process to make sure that the data is gathered in the most appropriate way, through accounts, profiles and tracking code customisations.



Structure of Account

Accounts & Properties

When deciding how to structure your Google Analytics account it is important to understand how many domains you will be tracking and what relationship they have with each other. In simple situations every top level domain (TLD) should have its own Google Analytics Account. This is particularly important if the domains in question are for separate companies.

Within an account you will have the property which sets the UA number for the account. This UA number is what is used on the site to push the data into the right property.

If a company has more than one domain then additional properties can be considered to keep the data separate yet under the same account.

For subdomains the ideal situation is to use the same account, property and profile as the TLD unless it is a separate business unit and users do not cross between this and the main TLD.

Where more than one domain or subdomain use the same account and property additional profiles can be created with filters to only show data from specific domains or subdomains (the hostname).

It is important to take in to account the following limits (for free accounts):

- Maximum number of profiles per account: 50
- Maximum number of visits per day: 50,000
- Maximum number of pageviews per day: 10 million (can be raised through use of AdWords)
- Maximum number of goals per profile: 20
- Timezone and currency can be set at profile level

Profiles & Filters

Profiles are used to break the data down within a Google Analytics property through the use of filters. Common filters you might consider include:

- Removing company IP addresses
- Show only data from a specific domain or subdomain
- Show data from one subfolder
- Specific countries

When new profiles and filters are set up the data is not backdated, it will begin recording once implemented.

When adding filters it is important to **always keep a profile with no filters** in order to preserve all raw data.

AdWords Accounts

If you use the Google AdWords platform for Pay per Click (PPC) advertising the account can be linked to Google Analytics to enable the data to be shared and additional insights to be gained. Conversion data can be imported from Google Analytics to Google AdWords. User journeys can be traced back to PPC keywords in Google Analytics. Highly targeted lists of users can be gathered in Google Analytics to then be used for remarketing campaigns in Google AdWords.

Previously Google Analytics accounts could only be linked to one AdWords account and vice versa. Happily, this limit has now been lifted and Google Analytics accounts can now be linked to more than one Google AdWords account and vice versa.

For step by step instructions on how to link your Google AdWords and Google Analytics follow this guide that I've already written:

<http://www.koozai.com/blog/pay-per-click-ppc/the-full-guide-to-remarketing-in-google-analytics-and-adwords/>

Tracking Code

Standard Tracking

Data can only be pushed into a Google Analytics account if tracking code with the account's UA number in it is fired on a page. This code is called the tracking snippet and needs to be on every page of the website and subdomains that you wish to track.

In December 2009 Google Analytics launched the asynchronous (async) version of their tracking code snippet to replace the traditional ga.js snippet. It is the async version that is currently the recommended snippet to use.

The async snippet is identified by the use of the gaq.push functions and is faster, more accurate and has improved functionality compared to the traditional tracking ga.js code. Prior to the traditional ga.js code it was urchin.js that was used which had even more limited functionality.

A basic set up with asynchronous code should look like this:

```
<script type="text/javascript">

var _gaq = _gaq || [];
_gaq.push(['_setAccount', 'UA-XXXXX-X']);
_gaq.push(['_trackPageview']);

(function() {
  var ga = document.createElement('script'); ga.type = 'text/javascript'; ga.async = true;
  ga.src = ('https:' == document.location.protocol ? 'https://ssl' : 'http://www') + '.google-
analytics.com/ga.js';
  var s = document.getElementsByTagName('script')[0]; s.parentNode.insertBefore(ga, s);
})();

</script>
```

Customisations are worked into this for the following types of additional functionality which we will cover below:

- Tracking between subdomains
- Tracking across top level domains
- Gathering remarketing data
- Pushing data to more than one account
- Setting Custom Variables

Subdomain and Cross Domain Tracking

If users cross between your domains during their visit and the domains are set up with the same Google Analytics account then cross domain and or sub domain tracking customisations need to be in place in order to keep the users Google Analytics cookie active throughout the different URLs as opposed to setting a new cookie when the user crosses between domains. This helps tie the user journey and conversion data together with the initial point of entry on the site.

Subdomain tracking simply requires on additional line of code (highlighted yellow):

```
<script type="text/javascript">

var _gaq = _gaq || [];
_gaq.push(['_setAccount', 'UA-XXXXX-X']);
_gaq.push(['_setAllowLinker', true]);
_gaq.push(['_trackPageview']);

(function() {
  var ga = document.createElement('script'); ga.type = 'text/javascript'; ga.async = true;
  ga.src = ('https:' == document.location.protocol ? 'https://ssl' : 'http://www') + '.google-
analytics.com/ga.js';
  var s = document.getElementsByTagName('script')[0]; s.parentNode.insertBefore(ga, s);
})();

</script>
```

Cross domain tracking requires two customisations. The first is another line of code to state which website the code is on (would be customised for each domain):

```
<script type="text/javascript">

var _gaq = _gaq || [];
_gaq.push(['_setAccount', 'UA-XXXXX-X']);
_gaq.push(['_setDomainName', '.current-domain.com']);
_gaq.push(['_setAllowLinker', true]);
_gaq.push(['_trackPageview']);

(function() {
  var ga = document.createElement('script'); ga.type = 'text/javascript'; ga.async = true;
  ga.src = ('https:' == document.location.protocol ? 'https://ssl' : 'http://www') + '.google-
analytics.com/ga.js';
  var s = document.getElementsByTagName('script')[0]; s.parentNode.insertBefore(ga, s);
})();

</script>
```

The second requirement for cross domain tracking is to tag all links between the two domains with code that pushes the users cookie across to make stop the move starting a new session:

```
<a href="http://www.other-domain.com/intro"
  onclick="_gaq.push(['_link', 'http://www.other-domain.com/intro']); return false;">See the other
website</a>
```

Forms also need the linkByPost function if they send users to one of your other domains:

```
<form name="f" method="post" onsubmit="_gaq.push(['_linkByPost', this]);">
```

Multiple Accounts

On rare occasions you will need to push data in to two Google Analytics properties from one page/website.

To do this the best method is known as 'roll up reporting' where two UA codes and track pageviews are pushed one after the other, like so:

```
<script type='text/javascript'>
    var _gaq = _gaq || [];
    //Main Account
    _gaq.push(['t1._setAccount', 'UA-XXXXXX-X']);
    _gaq.push(['t1._trackPageview']);

    // Account Number 2
    _gaq.push(['t2._setAccount', 'UA-YYYYYY-Y']);
    _gaq.push(['t2._trackPageview']);

    (function() {
        var ga = document.createElement('script'); ga.type = 'text/javascript'; ga.async = true;
        ga.src = ('https:' == document.location.protocol ? 'https://ssl' : 'http://www') + '.google-
analytics.com/ga.js';
        var s = document.getElementsByTagName('script')[0]; s.parentNode.insertBefore(ga, s);
    })();
</script>
```

Remarketing

In 2012, Google AdWords introduced Remarketing which is a great way of enticing visitors who have viewed your website to come back. This can be managed through Google Analytics by adding another cookie to the user's computer when they visit your site and then choosing which of these users to advertise to based on targeted lists that you can build in Google analytics.



The standard Google Analytics remarketing customisation can actually lead to lost data due to it triggering ad block software, however, by customising the code you can incorporate remarketing within Google Analytics and not lose data.

There are a number of steps required to set up and use remarketing which we have outlined in this blog post:

<http://www.koozai.com/blog/pay-per-click-ppc/the-full-guide-to-remarketing-in-google-analytics-and-adwords/>

Additional Tracking

Site Search

Internal search engine data can be pulled in to Google Analytics in order to help with analysis of search queries used on site, search success, refinements, exits and more.

In order for this to work the search engine on the site needs to have clear parameters, i.e when a search is carried out the URL may look like this "www.domain.com/?s=seo" where "s" is the parameter that defines the search term.

Category parameters can also be used if required.

Data is seen under Content > Site Search. You can then see reports for the search queries searched, pages on which searches were made and you can often find more insightful data if you click the blue links on the report.

Call Tracking

If a percentage of your business comes through phone calls rather than over the internet it is beneficial to use call tracking to tie the phone calls up with visitors. This helps you attribute calls as conversions and understand an otherwise hidden set of data.

Call tracking can be provided by external companies but also requires tags to be added to the site.

Conversion Tracking

It is very important to set up conversion tracking within Google Analytics as this is the way to measure the success of the site and identify whether or not it is achieving its objectives. We have covered Goals and Ecommerce set up and reporting in the first section of this document.

5. Google Analytics Glossary

By Graeme Bengie

If at any stage you've wondered what we're talking about, check this glossary to find out what the terms mean.



Visits

Google Analytics tracking code is triggered each time a user enters a site. A user's on site behaviour is then tracked during the course of that visit until they leave the site or if they are inactive for 30 minutes.

New Visits

Google Analytics uses cookies at a browser level to track visits to your site. These inform Google Analytics if you have accessed the site via the browser you're using. The following visits prompt a New visit record:

- First visit via browser, therefore a return visit via an alternate browser will be recorded as a new visit
- No cookie information available at the time of visit
- Cookie expired (after a 30 minute time limit)
- Cookie deleted

Returning Visits

Conversely, should a visitor access a site from the same browser as a prior visit, this is tracked as a Return visit. Should a visitor come to the site from another computer or browser they will be seen as a different visitor.

Visitors

Visits will always outnumber Visitors as this calculates Returning visitors and there will always be people who visit more than once.

To illustrate the difference: If you go to a site then you are a visitor. If someone else then uses your computer and the same browser they will be seen as the same visitor and no new record will be tracked. Should you then use a new computer or browser, you are seen as another visitor on Google as a new cookie is triggered. Google is not able to join the two visits together to one visitor as cookies are browser level not user level.

Bounce Rate

The 'Bounce Rate' is the percentage of visits that only viewed one page before leaving the site.

Bounce Rate should be as low as possible, as that shows that users are engaging with your site. However this is not always an accurate description of how visitors consume site content as there may be legitimate instances of a high Bounce Rate. Sites such as blogs will often see a higher Bounce Rate as many people only come to the site to read a post they have heard about.

Depending on the type of site a typical Bounce Rate could be between 30% and 50%. Bounce Rate can correlate with a positive effect on ranking performance if in the 0-30% bracket. Similarly Bounce Rate can correlate with a negative impact on ranking performance. Sites with Bounce Rates of 70% or more are likely to be seen as having low quality content.

Pageviews

Pageviews can be confused with visits. Total Pageviews are the sum of all pages visited by all visitors during all visits.

Site users will likely view a page several times whilst navigating around a site. It's a useful metric but made more insightful with a further metric; Unique Pageviews. This isolates the number of visitors to a page as opposed to visits

Pages per Visit

This metric averages the number of pages viewed by visitors during the course of all visits in a defined time period.

Dashboard

A great feature of the Google Analytics console is the ability to use Dashboards to visualise key data as an alternative to the pre-set reports. Default Dashboards, like custom Dashboards have several layout formats to tailor data. Users can view data as tables, pie charts or graphs.

Traffic & Traffic Sources

Traffic is an interchangeable term used to describe the amount of visits. Traffic sources highlights the place from which a visit has originated from. These are grouped together and shown in the form of Traffic Mediums such as:

- Organic – Non paid search traffic
- Referral – A visit to your site via a link on another site
- (none) – Traffic that navigated to your site by typing your URL into their browser. Or traffic that used a bookmark to access a site. Traffic that has not had data captured by the Google Analytics cookie will be allocated to this medium.
- CPC – Cost per Click or paid advertising through Google's Search or Display network. Any other paid or display advertising can be manually set up to be grouped under this Medium.

Content

Google Analytics can provide insight into a site's content. Useful reports include Top Landing Pages (which pages people enter the site on) and Top Content (the most viewed pages).

The Content reports reveal the following insights:

- Pageviews
- Unique pageviews
- Bounce rate
- Traffic sources
- Links clicked most on each page

Goals

Goals are measurements of specific actions carried out by your users. Goal completions normally take the form of the following:

- URL destination - the most popular goal often used to measure how many people see a specific page such as a Confirmation or Thank Your page
- Visit duration – used by blogs and game sites to measure visits that last longer than a site objective
- Pages per visit – triggered when the number of pages viewed during a visit exceeds a specified level
- Event occurred

Setting a goal to measure one of these behaviours will reveal insights into how content is consumed by visitors.

Ecommerce

For sites transacting online, Ecommerce reporting within Google Analytics provides transaction and revenue data for products and services sold online. This data can then be drilled down to standard Google Analytics metrics and dimensions in order to gain understanding into sales performance.

Regular Expressions

This name refers to code which is used to match a variety of options. They can be used in Goals, Advanced Segments, Filters and more.

Summary

This Whitepaper has covered a wide range of reports available and how to set up and customise your Google Analytics. There are additional areas of functionality that we also recommend using, which can be found explained on the links below:

If this has fired up your passion for web analytics, we recommend reading our Analytics Blog posts on Koozai.com and also check out our post on the [Top Ten Best Web Analytics Resources](#).

As so much is developing in Google Analytics at the moment and as there is so much to Google Analytics, this Whitepaper does not cover everything but will see updates in future to stay up to date and expand your knowledge even further!



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